HOW-TO GUIDE

Creating a Shared Mailbox in Microsoft 365

Centralizing IT Support Ticket Intake via a Shared Email Inbox

Document Type	Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)
Platform	Microsoft 365 Admin Center
Author	IT Administrator
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Skill Level	Entry-Level / Intermediate
Time to Complete	Approximately 15 minutes

1. Overview

This guide documents the process of creating a Shared Mailbox in Microsoft 365 to centralize IT support email communication. Rather than having tickets arrive in individual inboxes, this solution routes all IT requests to a single shared address (e.g., itsupport@company.com) that all IT staff can access and manage.

Business Problem

- IT support emails arrive in individual staff inboxes causing missed tickets
- No centralized tracking of incoming support requests
- Coverage gaps when staff are out of office
- No accountability for response times

Solution

A Microsoft 365 Shared Mailbox allows multiple IT team members to send and receive email from a single address without requiring a dedicated license. All team members can view, reply to, and manage tickets from one location.

2. Prerequisites

Admin Access	Global Admin or Exchange Admin role in Microsoft 365
Licenses	Shared mailboxes under 50GB do not require a paid license
Users	List of IT staff email addresses to grant access

Mailbox Address	Desired email address (e.g., itsupport@yourdomain.com)

3. Step-by-Step Configuration

3.1 Create the Shared Mailbox

Step	Action	Details / Navigation Path
1	**Sign in to Admin Center**	Go to admin.microsoft.com and sign in with Global Admin or Exchange Admin credentials
2	**Navigate to Shared Mailboxes**	Teams & groups > Shared mailboxes in the left navigation panel
3	**Add New Mailbox**	Click '+ Add a shared mailbox' button at the top of the page
4	**Enter Mailbox Name**	Display Name: 'IT Support' — this is what senders see in their address book
5	**Set Email Address**	Email address: itsupport@yourdomain.com — confirm domain from dropdown
6	**Save the Mailbox**	Click 'Save changes' — mailbox creation takes 1-2 minutes to complete

3.2 Add IT Staff Members

After the mailbox is created, grant access to IT team members so they can send and receive on behalf of the shared address.

Step	Action	Details / Navigation Path
7	**Open Mailbox Settings**	Click on the newly created 'IT Support' mailbox to open its settings panel
8	**Edit Members**	Under 'Members' section, click 'Edit' or 'View and manage members'
9	**Add Members**	Click '+ Add members', search for each IT staff member by name or email
10	**Confirm Permissions**	Members automatically receive 'Full Access' and 'Send As' permissions
11	**Save**	Click 'Save' — changes propagate within 30-60 minutes

3.3 Configure Outlook Access for IT Staff

IT team members can add the shared mailbox in Outlook without any additional setup if automapping is enabled (default). Alternatively, they can add it manually:

1. Open Outlook > File > Account Settings > Account Settings
2. Double-click the primary email account
3. Click More Settings > Advanced > Add
4. Type the shared mailbox address: itsupport@yourdomain.com
5. Click OK and Finish — the mailbox appears in the left navigation panel

4. Verification & Testing

After configuration, perform the following tests to confirm the mailbox is working correctly:

- Send a test email from an external account to itsupport@yourdomain.com
- Confirm the email appears in the shared mailbox for all IT members
- Reply to the test email from the shared mailbox and verify the 'From' field shows itsupport@yourdomain.com
- Confirm all IT staff can see the mailbox in their Outlook left panel
- Test that a member can mark an email as read and it reflects for all other members

5. Business Impact & Benefits

Centralization	All IT support requests arrive in one place — no missed tickets
Coverage	Any IT staff member can respond regardless of who is out of office
Accountability	Emails can be assigned and tracked within the shared inbox
Cost	No additional license required for mailboxes under 50GB
Scalability	Additional staff can be added in minutes via Admin Center
Professionalism	Users always email a consistent address — not a personal inbox

6. Troubleshooting

Issue	Resolution
Mailbox not appearing in Outlook	Allow up to 60 minutes for automapping. If still missing, add manually via Account Settings > Advanced > Add
Cannot send as shared mailbox	Verify the user has 'Send As' permission in Admin Center > Shared Mailbox > Members. Wait 30 mins for replication.
Emails not received by all members	Check that all members are listed under the mailbox. Confirm members are accessing the shared folder, not their personal inbox.

Mailbox address not available	The address may already be in use. Check Exchange Admin Center > Recipients for conflicts and choose an alternate alias.

7. Skills Demonstrated

This task demonstrates competency in the following areas:

- **Microsoft 365 Administration — Shared Mailbox creation and management**
- **Azure Active Directory — User and group permissions**
- **Exchange Online — Email routing and access control configuration**
- **IT Documentation — Writing professional SOPs for repeatable processes**
- **Help Desk Operations — Designing systems that improve ticket management workflows**

This document was created as part of an IT portfolio to demonstrate Microsoft 365 administration skills. For questions or to request access, contact the IT department.